



ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Prepositional Phrases & -ever / No Matter Expressions

A Complete Guide for Intermediate Learners

PART 1

Prep. Phrases

PART 2

because of / due
to

PART 3

despite / in spite

PART 4

-ever Words

PART 5

No Matter

PART 6

Quizzes



WHAT WE WILL COVER

01

What is a Prepositional Phrase?

Preposition + noun vs. adverb clause

02

because of / due to / on account of

Cause & reason expressions

03

in spite of / despite

Contrast & concession expressions

04

SPETION: Gerund after Prepositions

Preposition + V-ing

05

-ever Words

whoever / whatever / wherever / however

06

No Matter Expressions

no matter who/what/where/how

07

Comparison: -ever vs No Matter

Meaning chart + equivalents

08

Practice Quizzes

3 quizzes with full answers

01 | WHAT IS A PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE?



A prepositional phrase (preposition + noun/noun phrase) can replace an adverb clause (conjunction + subject + verb). The meaning is the same — the structure is shorter and more formal.

ADVERB CLAUSE

Conjunction + Subject +
Verb ...

*He chose that university
because it has a high reputation.*

because / since / although...

PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE

Preposition + Noun /
Noun Phrase

*He chose that university
because of its fine reputation.*

because of / due to / despite...

02 | PREPOSITIONAL PHRASES — Overview Table

Prep. Phrase	Equivalent Conjunction	Example Sentence
because of	because / since	Owls hunt in darkness because of their keen sense of smell.
due to	because / since	We stayed home due to the bad weather.
on account of	because / since	Visibility is poor today on account of air pollution.
in spite of	although / even though	Natural silk is prized in spite of similar artificial fabrics.
despite	although / even though	Despite its loss, the team is still in first place.

03 | CAUSE: because of / due to / on account of

All three mean 'because' — they are followed by a NOUN or NOUN PHRASE (not a full clause).

because of

= because / since

Clause:

Owls can hunt in total darkness because they have a remarkably keen sense of smell.

Owls can hunt in total darkness because of their remarkably keen sense of smell.

due to

= because / since

Clause:

Since it was cold, we stayed home.

We stayed home due to the bad weather.

on account of

= because / since

Clause:

Dinner was delayed because David came late.

Dinner was somewhat delayed on account of David's rather tardy arrival.

04 | CONTRAST: in spite of / despite

Both mean 'although / even though' — followed by a NOUN or NOUN PHRASE (not a full clause).

in spite of

Although similar artificial fabrics are available, natural silk is still highly prized.

Natural silk is still highly prized in spite of the availability of similar artificial fabrics.

Although the weather was terrible, they finished the match.

They finished the match in spite of the terrible weather.

despite

Although the team lost the last game, it is still in first place.

Despite its loss, the team is still in first place.

Although the company has assured the product is safe, many have stopped buying it.

Despite repeated assurance that the product is safe, many have stopped buying it.



05 | SPETION: Preposition + Gerund (V-ing)

When an action (verb) follows a preposition, the verb **MUST** become a GERUND (V-ing).

This is called a prepositional phrase with a gerund.

Preposition (because of / due to / in spite of / despite) + V-ing

despite + V-ing

Jack managed to eat a big lunch even though he had eaten an enormous breakfast.

→ **Jack managed to eat a big lunch despite having eaten an enormous breakfast.**

in spite of + V-ing

She passed the exam although she hadn't studied much.

→ **She passed the exam in spite of not having studied much.**

due to + V-ing

We were late because the driver drove slowly.

→ **We were late due to the driver driving slowly.**

on account of + V-ing

He missed the meeting because he arrived late.

→ **He missed the meeting on account of arriving late.**



06 | -EVER WORDS: whoever / whatever / wherever / however



All -ever words carry two meanings: (1) 'any' — not a specific one | (2) 'no matter who/what/where/how'

whoever

= any person / no matter who

- Whoever gains the most points wins.
- Whoever calls me, I will answer.

whatever

= anything / no matter what

- You can eat whatever you like.
- I will support you whatever happens.

wherever

= any place / no matter where

- Go wherever you want.
- She felt at home wherever she lived.

whichever

= any one from a group / no matter which

- Whichever team wins will play in the final.
- Whichever road we take, we'll arrive.

whenever

= any time / no matter when

- You may leave whenever you wish.
- Come visit whenever you want.

however

= any way/manner / no matter how

- However you solve it, you get the same answer.
- Students may dress however they please.



07 | NO MATTER Expressions



'No matter + wh-word' shows the result does NOT change — regardless of person, thing, place, or way. Emphasizes that the choice or condition is UNIMPORTANT.

No matter who

any person (doesn't matter which)

- No matter who calls me, I will not answer.
- No matter who wins the election, life will go on.

No matter which

any one from a limited group

- No matter which book you choose, return it tomorrow.
- No matter which road we take, we will arrive late.

No matter what

anything / regardless of situation

- No matter what happens, stay calm.
- I will support you no matter what.

No matter where

any place (place is unimportant)

- No matter where you go, remember your family.
- He feels confident no matter where he is.

No matter how

any way / degree (method unimportant)

- No matter how hard the task is, we will finish it.
- No matter how fast you run, you cannot catch that train.

08 | COMPARISON: -ever = No Matter = any + noun

-ever word	No matter...	Meaning (any...)	Example
whoever	no matter who	any person	Whoever wins, congratulate them.
whichever	no matter which	any one (group)	Whichever you choose, enjoy it.
whatever	no matter what	anything	Whatever you decide, I'll support you.
whenever	no matter when	any time	Whenever she calls, I'll answer.
wherever	no matter where	any place	Wherever you go, I'll find you.
however	no matter how	any way/degree	However hard it is, don't give up.



QUIZ 1 | Replace with a Prepositional Phrase

Rewrite using because of / due to / on account of / in spite of / despite. More than one answer may be correct.

1. Since the road was flooded, all buses were delayed.

2. Although she was tired, she continued working.

3. Because there was heavy snow, the school was closed.

4. Even though he had failed twice before, he tried again.

5. Dinner was late because David arrived late.

6. Although she hadn't studied, she passed the test.

QUIZ 1 | ANSWERS

due to / because of

All buses were delayed due to the flooded road.

→ *since* → *due to/because of + noun*

in spite of / despite

She continued working in spite of her tiredness.

→ *although* → *in spite of + noun*

due to / because of

The school was closed because of the heavy snow.

→ *because* → *because of + noun*

despite / in spite of

Despite having failed twice, he tried again.

→ *even though* → *despite + gerund (V-ing)*

on account of

Dinner was late on account of David's late arrival.

→ *because* → *on account of + noun phrase*

despite / in spite of

She passed the test despite not having studied.

→ *although* → *despite + gerund (negative)*



QUIZ 2 | Fill in: -ever or No Matter __

Complete each sentence with the correct -ever word or 'no matter' expression.

1. _____ you go, I will follow you.

2. _____ hard I try, I can't solve this puzzle.

3. You can watch _____ program you like on Friday nights.

4. _____ she goes, she always makes new friends.

5. _____ wins this match will play in the final.

6. I'll stand by you _____ happens.

7. _____ book you choose, read the first chapter tonight.

8. She smiled _____ someone spoke to her.

QUIZ 2 | ANSWERS

Wherever / No matter where you go, I will follow you.

→ any place → wherever / no matter where

You can watch whatever program you like on Friday nights.

→ any program → whatever

Whoever wins this match will play in the final.

→ any person → whoever

Whichever / No matter which book you choose, read the first chapter.

→ any one from a group → whichever

However / No matter how hard I try, I can't solve this puzzle.

→ any degree → however / no matter how

Wherever / No matter where she goes, she always makes friends.

→ any place → wherever

I'll stand by you whatever / no matter what happens.

→ anything → whatever / no matter what

Whenever someone spoke to her, she smiled.

→ any time → whenever



QUIZ 3 | Find & Fix the Mistake

Each sentence has ONE error. Identify and correct it.

1. We were late because of the road was flooded.

2. Despite she was tired, she kept on working.

3. Go whichever you like — all roads lead there.

4. In spite of to having no money, he paid the bill.

5. No matter what you said, I already made my decision.

6. However hard you will try, she won't listen.

QUIZ 3 | ANSWERS

✗ *because of the road was flooded*

✓ **because of the flooded road**

→ 'because of' needs a **NOUN**, not a full clause (no subject+verb after it).

✗ *Go whichever you like*

✓ **Go wherever you like**

→ 'whichever' is for choosing from a group.
'wherever' = any place.

✗ *No matter what you said*

✓ **No matter what you say / said (tense match)**

→ Tense consistency: 'already made' suggests present reference → 'say'.

✗ *Despite she was tired*

✓ **Despite her tiredness / Despite being tired**

→ 'despite' must be followed by a noun or V-ing, not 'subject + verb'.

✗ *in spite of to having no money*

✓ **in spite of having no money**

→ After 'in spite of', use V-ing directly — no 'to' needed.

✗ *However hard you will try*

✓ **However hard you try**

→ After 'however/no matter how', use **PRESENT** tense for future reference.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

Prepositional Phrases & -ever / No Matter



because of / due to / on account of = because/since (CAUSE)



in spite of / despite = although/even though (CONTRAST)



SPETION: After prepositions, verbs **MUST** become V-ing (gerund)



-ever = no matter + wh-word = any + noun (interchangeable!)



No matter expressions: result doesn't change regardless of condition